PARTICLES OF THE QUR'AN · 5

كَلَّا

Kallaa, Tanween and the Ending of Emphasis

Four small pieces you see on every page

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Particles of the Qur'an 5: Kallaa, Tanween and the Ending of Emphasis

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Particles of the Qur'an, part 5 of 5

We finish the particles with four small pieces you see on almost every page of the Qur'an.

1. "No! Never!": كَلَّا (kallaa)

The particle of stopping and scolding (*harf ar-rad'*, حَرْفُ الرَّدْعِ). It rejects what came before: "No, it is not as you think!"

In the Qur'an: كَلَّا سَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ "No! You will soon know" (102:3).

Sometimes it means "truly", like حَقًّا "truly, really": كَلَّا إِنَّ الْإِنسَانَ لَيَطْغَىٰ "Truly, man goes beyond limits" (96:6).

2. The two kinds of ت

- **The round ta (ة):** at the end of a noun it usually marks the feminine, as in جَنَّة "garden". It carries a vowel, so it is called "the moving ta" (*at-taa' al-mutaharrikah*, التَّاءُ الْمُتَحَرِّكَةُ).
- **The long ta (تْ):** at the end of a past verb it means "she". It carries a sukun, so it is called "the silent ta" (*at-taa' as-saakinah*, التَّاءُ السَّاكِنَةُ). فَلَمَّا سَمِعَتْ "when she heard" (12:31).

3. Tanween (nunation)

Tanween (*tanween*, تَنْوِين) is an "n" sound after the last vowel of a noun. It is written by doubling the vowel mark, not with a letter ن: كِتَابٌ "a book" (*kitaabun*), كِتَابًا (*kitaaban*), كِتَابٍ (*kitaabin*). It usually shows that the noun is indefinite ("*a* book"). It is not emphasis.

4. The ن of emphasis

The ن of emphasis (*noon at-tawkeed*, نُونُ التَّوْكِيدِ) is added to the end of a verb to make it stronger: "he *will certainly*...". It comes in two forms:

- **Heavy, with shadda (نَّ):** لَيُسْجَنَنَّ "he will surely be imprisoned" (12:32).
- **Light, with sukun (نْ):** وَلَيَكُونًا مِّنَ الصَّاغِرِينَ "and he will surely be among the humbled" (12:32). In the Qur'an the light ن is written like tanween. It appears only twice: here, and in لَنَسْفَعًا "We will surely drag" (96:15).

Both forms are in the same ayah, 12:32. The ن of emphasis goes only on verbs, mostly on commands, forbidding, questions, wishes, requests and oaths, as in these two examples, which follow an oath.

Check yourself

1. Which ت would you expect at the end of رَحْمَة "mercy", and why?
2. In لَيُسْجَنَنَّ, which letters are the emphasis?

Answers: (1) The round ة: it is a noun. (2) The final نَّ.

That completes the particles. **Next:** the 25 most common nouns in the Qur'an.

From my book Quran Grammar Summary *(second edition), section 1.5.*

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